

Krill are tiny, shrimplike crustaceans that provide food for animals ranging from small fish to the largest whales.

Antarctic krill

TO
AFRICA

Antarctic brittle star

This relative of the starfish can lose an arm if attacked—and grow it back!

Pure white except for their black eyes and bills, snow petrels have even been seen at the South Pole.

Snow petrel

The colossal squid is the biggest squid on Earth. It also has the largest eyes of any animal.

Colossal squid

East Antarctica

The size of a large gull, the skua takes penguin eggs and chicks for food.

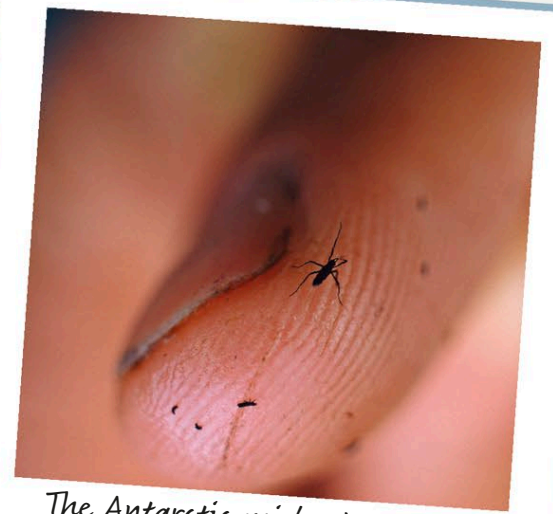
South polar skua

TRANSANTARCTIC MOUNTAINS

This penguin is 28 in (71 cm) high and makes its nest out of stones, sometimes stealing rocks from its neighbors.

Adélie penguin

TO
AUSTRALIA



The Antarctic midge looks tiny when shown on a human finger.

Antarctic midge

Antarctica's only insect, this midge lives on the rocky Antarctic Peninsula, which juts out into the Southern Ocean. It is wingless and eats algae and bacteria. Adult midges live just seven to ten days, but their young can survive two winters.

Emperor penguin

The emperor penguin is the only animal to survive Antarctica's ice in winter. It stays snug with its waterproof coat and four layers of feathers. Males keep the eggs warm by holding them on their feet off of the chilly ice.

Emperor penguin chicks are covered in fluffy gray down, which is not waterproof.

